# MaxBits · Daily Tech Watch

High-quality technology news from around the world.

Daily brief · 2026-10-18

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**Last 7 daily reports**

## 3 deep-dives you should really read

### Roundtables: A Conversation With the Creator of AI-Designed Viruses

MIT Technology Review – Tech · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** A Stanford PhD student utilized a generative AI model to design preliminary genetic blueprints for microscopic viruses, demonstrating AI's capacity in synthetic biology.
- **Who:** Stanford University PhD student Samuel King, using a generative AI model, developed genetic blueprints for viruses, pushing the boundaries of AI in life sciences.
- **What it does:** It enables AI to propose genetic blueprints for novel microscopic viruses, presenting a foundational step towards potential AI-generated life forms in the future.
- **Why it matters:** This development signifies AI's burgeoning ability to design biological entities, prompting critical discussions on bio-security, ethical implications, and regulatory frameworks for advanced AI.
- **Strategic view:** TMT executives must prepare for AI's profound impact on biotechnology and healthcare, necessitating investment in secure AI development and anticipating future regulatory and ethical governance challenges.

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### This implant can restore sight for patients with macular degeneration

MIT Technology Review – Tech · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** The PRIMA system is a novel retinal implant designed to restore vision for patients suffering from advanced age-related macular degeneration.
- **Who:** The PRIMA system targets millions of patients globally with advanced macular degeneration, involving medical technology developers and regulatory bodies.
- **What it does:** This system directly restores lost vision by functionally replacing dead retinal cells, offering a significant breakthrough for an untreatable degenerative eye condition.
- **Why it matters:** It matters because it represents the first effective treatment to restore vision for a previously untreatable form of advanced macular degeneration affecting millions worldwide.
- **Strategic view:** This signifies expanding frontiers in bio-integrated tech, driving demand for advanced AI diagnostics, secure health data infrastructure, and accessible media experiences across TMT sectors.

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### As AI safety concerns mount, three pioneers make the case for staying open

TechCrunch – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Three prominent AI pioneers debated key issues surrounding AI development, safety, and global competition at the Ai4 conference.
- **Who:** Geoffrey Hinton, Fei-Fei Li, and Andrew Ng, leading AI experts, publicly discussed AI regulation, open source access, and international competitive dynamics.
- **What it does:** They publicly advocated for open development and debated the efficacy of various regulatory approaches amidst rising global AI safety concerns and geopolitical competition.
- **Why it matters:** Their discussion highlights critical industry tensions regarding innovation pace, ethical governance, and the imperative for companies to balance risk with technological advancement.
- **Strategic view:** Executives must navigate the complex interplay of open innovation, responsible AI deployment, and national competitiveness to secure future market leadership and societal trust.

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## CEO POV · AI & Space Economy

No CEO statements collected for today.

## Patent watch · Compute / Video / Data / Cloud

No relevant patent publications detected for today (EPO / USPTO).

## Curated watchlist · 3–5 links per topic

### TV / Streaming

No notable articles for this topic today.

### Telco / 5G

No notable articles for this topic today.

### Media / Platforms

No notable articles for this topic today.

### AI / Cloud / Quantum

- Meta to add 100MW of solar power from US gear (TechCrunch – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- Breakneck data center growth challenges Microsoft’s sustainability goals (TechCrunch – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- Data centers love solar: Here’s a comprehensive guide to deals over 100 megawatts (TechCrunch – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- Geothermal could power nearly all new data centers through 2030 (TechCrunch – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- ElevenLabs now lets authors create and publish audiobooks on its own platform (TechCrunch – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly

### Space / Infrastructure

No notable articles for this topic today.

### Robotics / Automation

No notable articles for this topic today.

### Broadcast / Video

No notable articles for this topic today.

### Satellite / Satcom

No notable articles for this topic today.